

State Entry Pack — Texas, hvac

Assembled for Sila Mechanical on 2026-09-04.

The answer, first

To do HVAC contracting in Texas you need the Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A, issued by Texas Department of Licensing and Regulation — Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractors. The board's own words on who must hold it: Any person contracting to install, repair or maintain air conditioning, refrigeration or heating systems; each permanent company location must employ a licensed ACR contractor.

What Texas does not publish

6 requirement(s) below are not published by this board, or we could not establish them from a public page. They are named here, before anything we do know. We never estimate a fee, an hour count or a processing time.

Texas — Typical processing time: not published

What we read: TDLR publishes no end-to-end processing time for an ACR contractor licence. The only published duration is the criminal-history review: 'a review can take from one to six weeks to complete'. Quoting that as the licence timeline would be wrong, so the field stays empty and the playbook says so.

Ask Texas Department of Licensing and Regulation — Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractors: How long does a complete application currently take to process?

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/>

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A — Bond: not published

What we read: No bond requirement appears on the TDLR ACR apply, renew, CE or reciprocity pages, all four of which were read in full. This is recorded as 'not established', NOT as 'no bond required' — the difference matters to a contractor bidding a job.

Ask Texas Department of Licensing and Regulation — Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractors: Does this licence class require a surety bond, and in what amount?

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/>

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A — Bond amount: not published

What we read: see bond.required

Ask Texas Department of Licensing and Regulation — Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractors: What bond amount does this licence class require?

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/>

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class B — Examination fee: not published

Ask Texas Department of Licensing and Regulation — Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractors: What is the current examination fee?

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/>

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class B — Bond: not published

What we read: see Class A: no bond requirement found on the TDLR ACR pages

Ask Texas Department of Licensing and Regulation — Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractors: Does this licence class require a surety bond, and in what amount?

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/>

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class B — Bond amount: not published

What we read: see bond.required

Ask Texas Department of Licensing and Regulation — Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractors: What bond amount does this licence class require?

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/>

The Entry Pack Guarantee

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against the board's published page, not against a conversation. Our liability is limited to the fee you paid for that pack.

StateReady is a tracking and research tool. It is not legal advice and it is not a licensing service. Every value shows the board page it came from and the date we last checked it; anything we could not establish from a public source is shown as unestablished, never estimated. The licensing board, not StateReady, is the authority on your licence.

Who issues what

Texas Department of Licensing and Regulation — Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractors (hvac)

HVAC/refrigeration contractor licences and technician registrations, statewide

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/> · (800) 803-9202

8 value(s) we could not fully verify

Each of these is printed with the value we read and the reason it is flagged. Confirm them with the board before you rely on them.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A — Examination fee: \$74

We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

The \$74 figure is printed in the class-upgrade section of the renewal page. It is the ACR examination fee, but the initial-application page does not repeat it, so confidence is medium, not high.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A — How the hours may be taken: Online courses are available from providers that offer them; no classroom minimum is stated.

We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A — Aggregate minimum: \$600,000

We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

Read from the Class A row of the minimum-coverage table.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A — Property damage minimum: \$300,000

We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

Products and completed operations aggregate, Class A row.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class B — Aggregate minimum: \$200,000

We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

Class B row of the minimum-coverage table: \$100,000 per occurrence / \$200,000 aggregate / \$100,000 products and completed operations.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class B — Property damage minimum: \$100,000

We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

Texas — Written examination: waived

We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

The reciprocity page describes the exam as conditional ('if applicable') rather than stating a waiver in terms. Medium confidence; the expansion playbook flags it for human check.

Texas — Written examination: waived

We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

Texas — hvac

Two trades are two sections. Nothing below is merged with any other trade's advice.

1. Which licence the work requires, and who must hold it

Start here. Writing to the wrong agency is the most expensive mistake in this process, so the board that issues each licence is named beside it.

Texas, statewide

How this state licenses the trade: A single TDLR Air Conditioning and Refrigeration contractor licence covers the whole state. No separate municipal contractor licence is named on the board's pages.

"Contractors who install, repair, or maintain systems related to air conditioning, refrigeration, or heating must have a TDLR license"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/> · checked 2026-09-03

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A

Who must hold it: Any person contracting to install, repair or maintain air conditioning, refrigeration or heating systems; each permanent company location must employ a licensed ACR contractor.

"ACR companies must employ an ACR contractor in each permanent location"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/> · checked 2026-09-03

What it covers: Any size unit.

"The Class A license allows you to work on any size unit."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class B

Who must hold it: As Class A, but the licence limits the size of system that may be worked on.

"The Class B license allows you to work on cooling systems of 25 tons and under"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

What it covers: Cooling systems of 25 tons and under; heating systems of 1.5 million BTU/h and under.

"cooling systems of 25 tons and under, and heating systems of 1.5 million BTUs/hour and under"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

2. Examination, experience — and whether a licence you already hold helps

Reciprocity usually runs one way. What follows is what this state's own board publishes about licences issued elsewhere, matched against the licences you told us you hold.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A

Examination: required

"TDLR will approve your eligibility to take the licensing exam"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Experience required: 48 months of practical ACR work under a licensed ACR contractor within the past 72 months.

"at least 48 months of practical experience in air-conditioning and refrigeration-related work"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Accepted alternatives to that experience: Technician certification held for 12 months plus 36 months of practical experience within the past 48 months; or a degree/diploma/certification in ACR, a mechanical-engineering degree or licence, military ACR training, or employment by an industrial operation.

"You have held a technician certification for the past 12 months"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class B

Examination: required

"TDLR will approve your eligibility to take the licensing exam"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Experience required: Same as Class A.

"To be eligible for licensure, you must meet one of the following experience requirements"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

What the board says about reciprocity

The board's own summary of its agreements: Two agreements only: South Carolina and Georgia.

"Texas currently has reciprocal licensing agreements with South Carolina and Georgia."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrreciprocity.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Georgia -> Texas

What this state grants: Texas Class A, Environmental Air Conditioning

"Holding this license in good standing will qualify you for a Texas Class A, Environmental Air Conditioning License."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrreciprocity.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

On these conditions: Held for at least one year; no other Georgia licence is accepted.

"You must have held an out of state license for at least one year in order to reciprocate."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrreciprocity.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Written examination: waived

"the licensing exam that you will take (if applicable)"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrreciprocity.htm> · checked 2026-09-03 · medium confidence

Needs checking — We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

The reciprocity page describes the exam as conditional ('if applicable') rather than stating a waiver in terms. Medium confidence; the expansion playbook flags it for human check.

South Carolina -> Texas

What this state grants: Mapped by licence: SC Air Conditioning, Heating -> TX Class A Environmental Air Conditioning and Commercial Refrigeration; SC Air Conditioning -> TX Class A Commercial Refrigeration and Class B Environmental Air Conditioning; SC Mechanical Contractor, Refrigeration -> TX Class A Commercial Refrigeration; SC Air Conditioning and Heating (Packaged equipment) -> TX Class B Environmental Air Conditioning.

"Texas recognizes the following licensing equivalencies from South Carolina"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrreciprocity.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

On these conditions: Letter of good standing confirming a passed licensing exam in that state, plus the full Texas application and the \$115 fee. A South Carolina heating licence does not qualify.

"A South Carolina heating license does not qualify in Texas."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrreciprocity.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Written examination: waived

"The letter must also indicate that you have taken and passed a licensing exam in that state."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrreciprocity.htm> · checked 2026-09-03 · medium confidence

Needs checking — We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

3. Bond

What the board publishes about surety bonds for this licence class — and, where it publishes nothing, that it publishes nothing.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A

Bond: not published

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · low confidence

No bond requirement appears on the TDLR ACR apply, renew, CE or reciprocity pages, all four of which were read in full. This

is recorded as 'not established', NOT as 'no bond required' — the difference matters to a contractor bidding a job.

Ask the board: Does this licence class require a surety bond, and in what amount?

Bond amount: not published

Source: low confidence

see bond.required

Ask the board: What bond amount does this licence class require?

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class B

Bond: not published

Source: low confidence

see Class A: no bond requirement found on the TDLR ACR pages

Ask the board: Does this licence class require a surety bond, and in what amount?

Bond amount: not published

Source: low confidence

see bond.required

Ask the board: What bond amount does this licence class require?

4. Insurance

The certificate of insurance the board asks for, with the limits it names.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A

General liability minimum: \$300,000 per occurrence

"Class A License | \$300,000"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Commercial general liability, per occurrence, property damage and bodily injury combined. Must be maintained at all times while the licence is active.

Aggregate minimum: \$600,000

"Aggregate for Property Damage and Bodily Injury"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03 · medium confidence

Needs checking — We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

Read from the Class A row of the minimum-coverage table.

Property damage minimum: \$300,000

"Aggregate for Products and Completed Operations"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03 · medium confidence

Needs checking — We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

Products and completed operations aggregate, Class A row.

Workers' compensation: not published

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · low confidence

The ACR pages do not state a workers'-compensation requirement (the TDLR electrician pages do). Not established rather than not required.

Ask the board: Is workers' compensation coverage a condition of this licence?

Financial responsibility: not published

Source: low confidence

No credit or net-worth test appears on the TDLR ACR pages.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class B

General liability minimum: \$100,000 per occurrence

"Class B License | \$100,000"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Aggregate minimum: \$200,000

"Class B License | \$100,000"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03 · medium confidence

Needs checking — We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

Class B row of the minimum-coverage table: \$100,000 per occurrence / \$200,000 aggregate / \$100,000 products and completed operations.

Property damage minimum: \$100,000

"Class B License | \$100,000"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03 · medium confidence

Needs checking — We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

5. The qualifying individual and the company itself

Who in your company can hold the licence, whether the company registers separately, and what happens when that person leaves.

Texas, statewide

Who qualifies the company: Every permanent company location must employ a licensed ACR contractor.

"ACR companies must employ an ACR contractor in each permanent location"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/> · checked 2026-09-03

Per location or per company: Per permanent location, not per company.

"in each permanent location"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/> · checked 2026-09-03

This is the field that turns a Texas branch opening into a licensing event. A roll-up that acquires a second Texas branch needs a second licensed ACR contractor there, not just a second address.

Company registration: not published

Source: low confidence

Secretary-of-State registration requirements were not read in this pass; they are a Texas SOS matter, not a TDLR one.

Ask the board: Must the company itself register with the board, separately from the qualifier's licence?

Notice when the qualifier leaves: not published

Source: low confidence

No deadline for replacing a departed ACR contractor of record appears on the TDLR ACR pages read.

Ask the board: How long do we have to notify you when our qualifying individual leaves?

6. Fees, renewal and continuing education

What it costs to obtain the licence, what it costs to keep it, and the continuing education that keeps it current.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class A

Examination fee: \$74

"pay the examination fee of \$74"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-renew.htm> · checked 2026-09-03 · medium confidence

Needs checking — We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

The \$74 figure is printed in the class-upgrade section of the renewal page. It is the ACR examination fee, but the initial-application page does not repeat it, so confidence is medium, not high.

Application fee: \$115

"along with the fee of \$115"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Renewal cycle: 12 months

"Licenses are valid for a period of 1 year from the date of issue."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Renewal fee: \$65

"along with the renewal fee of \$65"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-renew.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

When it expires: anniversary

"Licenses are valid for a period of 1 year from the date of issue."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Expiry = issue date + 12 months, per licence. The rules engine derives it from the licence's own issue date; there is no state-wide common expiry date.

Grace period: None for practising. Late renewal is possible but the licence is not valid meanwhile.

"You may not engage in air conditioning and refrigeration contracting if your license has expired."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-renew.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Late renewal: 1.5x the renewal fee if expired 90 days or less; 2x if expired more than 90 days and under 18 months; 2x with executive-director approval from 18 months to 3 years.

"a renewal fee that is equal to 1-1/2 times the normally required renewal fee"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-renew.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Continuing education: required

"you must complete 8 hours of continuing education"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrce.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

CE hours: 8 hours

"you must complete 8 hours of continuing education"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrce.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

CE period: 12 months

"must complete 8 hours of approved continuing education coursework each year"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-renew.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Tied to the licence term, which is 12 months. Courses must be completed before expiry.

CE subjects: 1 hour — Texas state law and rules regulating licensee conduct

"including one hour of instruction in Texas state law and rules"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrce.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Approved providers: Department-approved providers only; a repeated course does not count twice.

"Only courses approved by the department will be accepted."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrce.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Carry-over of surplus hours: not published

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrce.htm> · low confidence

No carry-over provision appears on the TDLR ACR continuing-education page. Absence of a statement, not a statement of absence.

Ask the board: May surplus CE hours be carried into the next period?

How the hours may be taken: Online courses are available from providers that offer them; no classroom minimum is stated.

"Some providers offer online courses for continuing education."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrce.htm> · checked 2026-09-03 · medium confidence

Needs checking — We read this on the board's page but the page does not state it plainly for this licence class, so it carries our reading as well as the board's words. Confirm it with the board before you rely on it.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor — Class B

Application fee: \$115

"along with the fee of \$115"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Renewal cycle: 12 months

"Licenses are valid for a period of 1 year from the date of issue."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Renewal fee: \$65

"along with the renewal fee of \$65"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-renew.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

When it expires: anniversary

"Licenses are valid for a period of 1 year from the date of issue."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Continuing education: required

"you must complete 8 hours of continuing education"

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrce.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

CE hours: 8 hours

"you must complete 8 hours of continuing education"

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Approved providers: Department-approved providers only.

"Only courses approved by the department will be accepted."

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrce.htm> · checked 2026-09-03

Examination fee: not published

Source: low confidence

Ask the board: What is the current examination fee?

7. The filing sequence, and how long it takes

Assembled only from durations the board actually publishes. Where it publishes none, this section says so and names the office to ring. We never write an estimate here.

Texas, statewide

Typical processing time: not published

Source: <https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · low confidence

TDLR publishes no end-to-end processing time for an ACR contractor licence. The only published duration is the criminal-history review: 'a review can take from one to six weeks to complete'. Quoting that as the licence timeline would be wrong, so the field stays empty and the playbook says so.

Ask the board: How long does a complete application currently take to process?

8. Every page we read, and the day we read it

Every page behind every value above, with the day we last read it. Open any of them beside this document; that is what it is for.

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractors Homepage — TDLR

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/> · read 2026-09-03

Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Continuing Education — TDLR

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrce.htm> · read 2026-09-03

Licensing Reciprocity for Air Conditioning and Refrigeration — TDLR

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/acrreciprocity.htm> · read 2026-09-03

Apply for an Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor License — TDLR

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-apply.htm> · read 2026-09-03

Renew an Air Conditioning and Refrigeration Contractor License — TDLR

<https://www.tdlr.texas.gov/acr/contractor-renew.htm> · read 2026-09-03

What this record does not cover

Technician registration and technician certification (the credentials most of a Texas HVAC roster actually holds) are NOT populated in this record. Only the two contractor licence classes are. A customer tracking 40 Texas technicians will get renewal maths for their two contractor licences and nothing for the technicians until the wave-2 pass.

Endorsements (Environmental Air Conditioning, Commercial Refrigeration, Process Cooling/Heating) are described in the scope notes but are not modelled as separate trackable objects.